



A PRABHAKAR RAO

**NALSAR STUDENTS
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OUTSTANDING
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DUE TO THE
EXCELLENT TRAINING**

The school's students also qualified for the quarter final round of the international rounds of the Philip C. Jessup competition in Washington DC. On the fun side, the school hosts Strawberry Fields, India's largest student-organised rock show, while the NLS Debate, South Asia's largest parliamentary style debating tournament, is a big attraction in India, Pakistan, Bangladesh and Sri Lanka on the serious side.

While the recession hit recruitments even among prestigious business schools, NLSIU remained recession proof with 100 per cent placement. The school's Rs 2-crore library has 70,000 books and has added a few rooms for visiting moot court teams apart from adding an all-wired computer lab for students. The school is working on networking law libraries in India to set up a National Legal Information Centre. The school, established in 1987 after a statute was enacted for that purpose by the Karnataka Legislative Assembly, is hoping to expand its infrastructure so it can take more students. Union Minister for Law and Justice M. Veerappa Moily, a lawyer himself, has assured the school help in boosting infrastructure. Harvard University-trained lawyer and NLSIU alumnus Prashant Deshpande says, "What is unique in this school is the mix of liberal arts and social sciences in the five-year undergraduate course and the range like history or political science along with regular legal subjects." Deshpande, who essays the role of a legal practitioner and an active political worker for a leading national party, says it was the law school training that forced him to look at playing a key role in the Indian political space.

Just like the alumni of IITs have been supporting their alma mater, the NLSIU alumni who are based in more than

20 countries are gearing up to give back to the law school their *guru dakshina*, i.e. paying something out of gratitude.

Conferences such as Focus India are one of the key beginnings in this endeavour. Held by NLSIU alumni at the school campus in May 2009, it debated critical economic and legal issues. NLSIU Vice-Chancellor Venkata Rao, who has taught for over 30 years, says, "For years, they have been saying the National Law School is a Harvard of the East but our vision is to make people call Harvard the Bangalore of the West. Till then, we won't rest."

Neither will its close rival, the National Academy of Legal Studies and Research (NALSAR) University of Law. The six-year-old NALSAR in the northern suburbs of Hyderabad is setting new standards in legal education. "We offer courses in frontier areas where specific laws contribute to changes like in the realty, aviation and space, risk and insurance management and environment protection. The graduating students enjoy an outstanding placement rate because the bar, law firms, corporations and government agencies know that our graduates are equipped with problem-solving techniques and practical hands-on skills," says NALSAR Vice-Chancellor Veer Singh. Reflective of this rapid growth in a short span of time is NALSAR reaching an understanding with 21 foreign universities for exchange of students, faculty and collaborative research. Microsoft has signed an MoU for providing scholarships for three students every year for undertaking research in Intellectual Property Rights. With such credentials, this year's topper NLSIU needs to constantly look over its shoulder.

with Amarnath K. Menon